

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form US-CORE-C

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. What was President Roosevelt's primary motivation for attempting to add justices to the Supreme Court in 1937?

- A. To fulfill a campaign promise he had made to expand the Court to include more diverse justices
- B. To reduce the workload on existing justices who were overwhelmed by the volume of Depression-era cases
- C. To add justices who would be more likely to uphold New Deal programs that the Court had been striking down
- D. To ensure that justices who had served beyond the constitutional age limit would be replaced

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: After the Supreme Court struck down major New Deal programs including the NRA and AAA, FDR proposed the Judicial Procedures Reform Bill to add up to six new justices — openly designed to shift the Court's ideological balance in his favor.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.4 · b 0.5 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

2. Critics of the New Deal charged that Roosevelt's programs represented a dangerous move toward socialism. Defenders argued the New Deal actually saved capitalism. Which reasoning provides the strongest defense of the argument that the New Deal PRESERVED rather than threatened the capitalist system?

- A. The New Deal preserved capitalism because it was funded entirely through taxation and borrowing rather than government ownership of businesses, ensuring that private enterprise remained the foundation of the American economy.
- B. The New Deal preserved capitalism because FDR's willingness to accept deficit spending demonstrated that a capitalist democracy could respond to crises more flexibly than socialist command economies.
- C. The New Deal preserved capitalism because Roosevelt explicitly rejected socialist proposals such as nationalizing the banking system, choosing instead to restore private banks to profitability through the FDIC.
- D. The New Deal preserved capitalism by using government power to restore the conditions market economies require — consumer purchasing power, banking stability, and honest financial markets — preventing the complete collapse that was fueling calls for genuinely radical alternatives.

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: The strongest argument that the New Deal saved capitalism is that it used government intervention to restore the basic conditions that market economies require to function: consumer purchasing power (through relief and job programs), bank stability (FDIC), honest securities markets (SEC), and labor peace (NLRA/Fair Labor Standards). Without these stabilizers, capitalism itself was collapsing into mass unemployment, bank runs, and social unrest that threatened revolution. The New Deal reformed the system to preserve it — the opposite of socialism, which would have replaced private ownership. Students must evaluate a complex historical interpretation, not recall a definition.

Item analysis

Standard

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DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.79 · b 0.86 · c 0.23 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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3. How did the Truman Doctrine and the Marshall Plan work together to advance the U.S. policy of containment in Europe after World War II?

- A. The Truman Doctrine offered military and political support to countries resisting communist takeover, while the Marshall Plan provided economic aid to rebuild war-devastated nations
- B. The Truman Doctrine provided military aid to rebuild European industries, while the Marshall Plan trained European armies
- C. The Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan replaced the United Nations as the primary international peacekeeping organization
- D. Both programs were designed solely to counter the Soviet Union in Asia rather than in Europe

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Truman Doctrine (1947) pledged U.S. support to free peoples resisting communist pressure; the Marshall Plan (1948) funded European economic recovery to reduce the political appeal of communism.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b -0.3 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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4. Which conclusion about the Marshall Plan is best supported by the fact that it offered economic reconstruction aid to all European nations, including those within the Soviet sphere of influence?

- A. The offer to Soviet-aligned nations demonstrated that the United States did not yet view the Soviet Union as a long-term strategic adversary.
- B. American policymakers believed that economic recovery would reduce the appeal of communist political movements in war-devastated European nations.
- C. The Marshall Plan was designed primarily as a humanitarian relief program to prevent civilian starvation in postwar Europe.
- D. American policymakers genuinely expected the Soviet Union to participate in the Marshall Plan and integrate its economy into Western trade networks.

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: Secretary of State Marshall and the State Department's planning explicitly identified economic desperation as the primary recruiter for communist parties in Western Europe. Rebuilding prosperity was a strategic counter to Soviet political influence, not merely humanitarian charity.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 1 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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5. What happened to Prince Edward County, Virginia schools after Brown v. Board?

- A. They immediately integrated without any resistance from local officials
- B. They successfully maintained segregation through legal loopholes
- C. They closed public schools for five years rather than integrate
- D. They became a model for peaceful integration in the South

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.74

Why the key is right: Prince Edward County, Virginia, shut down its public schools for five years rather than obey desegregation orders after Brown. Choices about peaceful compliance are wrong because local officials chose closure over integration. The county became one of the clearest examples of how far segregationists would go to resist Brown.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of Brown v. Board of Education on the desegregation of schools, such as Scarboro 85, Clinton 12 and Little Rock 9. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.02 · b -0.71 · c 0.24 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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6. Why did many Southern states resist implementing the Brown v. Board of Education ruling even years after the 1954 decision?

- A. The Supreme Court's ruling lacked enforcement authority, so states could legally ignore federal court orders without consequence
- B. Congress had passed legislation blocking the enforcement of the ruling in states that had voted against integration
- C. The ruling only applied to schools in states where segregation had been challenged in court, leaving most Southern schools unaffected
- D. The Court's instruction to desegregate 'with all deliberate speed' allowed states to delay implementation, and local officials used political and social pressure to resist change

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.74

Why the key is right: The Brown II ruling (1955) used the vague phrase 'with all deliberate speed,' which Southern states exploited to delay desegregation. Massive Resistance campaigns, including the Southern Manifesto signed by 101 congressmen (U.S. House History, Art & Archives — 82 Representatives and 19 Senators), reinforced local defiance.

Item analysis

Standard

US.74 — Examine the decision and impacts of Brown v. Board of Education on the desegregation of schools, such as Scarboro 85, Clinton 12 and Little Rock 9. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

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a 1.4 · b 0.3 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

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Bias / sensitivity

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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7. What organization did Martin Luther King Jr. help found after the Montgomery Bus Boycott?

- A. The Southern Christian Leadership Conference to coordinate civil rights efforts
- B. Using peaceful protests to create tension that forces negotiation and change
- C. He became the first African American student at the University of Mississippi
- D. He was a Birmingham civil rights leader who helped organize the 1963 campaign

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.76

Why the key is right: The Montgomery Bus Boycott began after Rosa Parks's arrest and kept pressure on the city until bus segregation was struck down in court. Choices about voting drives or lunch counters are wrong because the boycott focused specifically on segregated public transportation in 1955–1956. It showed the strength of organized nonviolent protest and launched Martin Luther King Jr. to national prominence.

Item analysis

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.12 · b -1.72 · c 0.24 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

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Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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8. How did Orval Faubus's actions during the Little Rock Crisis of 1957 reflect the broader pattern of Southern resistance to civil rights?

- A. Faubus refused to enforce segregation laws after the Supreme Court's ruling, making Little Rock a model of voluntary compliance
- B. Faubus used the Arkansas National Guard to block Black students from entering Central High School, directly defying federal authority and forcing President Eisenhower to respond with federal troops
- C. Faubus supported the federal government's desegregation orders and called on the National Guard to protect Black students entering Central High School
- D. Faubus appealed to Congress to pass legislation overturning the Brown decision, making Little Rock a political rather than a military confrontation

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.76

Why the key is right: Faubus's use of state military forces to block federally mandated integration forced Eisenhower to federalize the Arkansas National Guard and send the 101st Airborne Division, establishing a precedent for federal enforcement of civil rights.

Item analysis

Standard

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

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Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

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9. How did the Civil Rights Act of 1964 build upon and go beyond earlier civil rights legislation?

- A. The 1964 Act required immediate desegregation of all schools within one year, accelerating the timeline set by *Brown v. Board*
- B. The 1964 Act was the first federal law to address racial discrimination since Reconstruction, as Congress had not passed any civil rights legislation in the twentieth century before 1964
- C. The 1964 Act prohibited discrimination in public accommodations, employment, and federally assisted programs, addressing areas of daily life that earlier, weaker civil rights acts had not protected
- D. The 1964 Act focused exclusively on voting rights, extending protections that earlier acts had established for school integration

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.78

Why the key is right: The 1964 Civil Rights Act was the most comprehensive civil rights legislation since Reconstruction. It banned discrimination in public accommodations (Title II), employment (Title VII), and programs receiving federal funding (Title VI), closing gaps in earlier weak legislation.

Item analysis

Standard

US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

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IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Citation

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Historian review

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10. African American voter registration in the southern states covered by the Voting Rights Act of 1965 rose from approximately 29% in 1965 to over 60% by 1969. Which conclusion is best supported by this trend?

- A.** African American voter registration declined sharply between 1965 and 1968
- B.** Mississippi had the highest African American voter registration rate in 1965
- C.** Voter registration rates remained constant in the South during this period
- D.** African American voter registration in the South increased dramatically after the Voting Rights Act

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.78

Why the key is right: African American voter registration in the seven southern states covered by Section 5 of the Voting Rights Act rose from approximately 29% in 1965 to over 60% by 1969, with Mississippi seeing the most dramatic gain (from 6.7% in 1965 to 59.8% by 1967 (USCCR Political Participation, 1968)). Federal examiners and the Section 5 preclearance requirement accelerated registration where literacy tests and intimidation had previously suppressed it. Source: U.S. Commission on Civil Rights, 'The Voting Rights Act: Ten Years After' (1975).

Item analysis

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US.78 — Analyze civil and voting rights legislation, including the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (i.e., Fair Housing Act), and the 24th Amendment. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

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